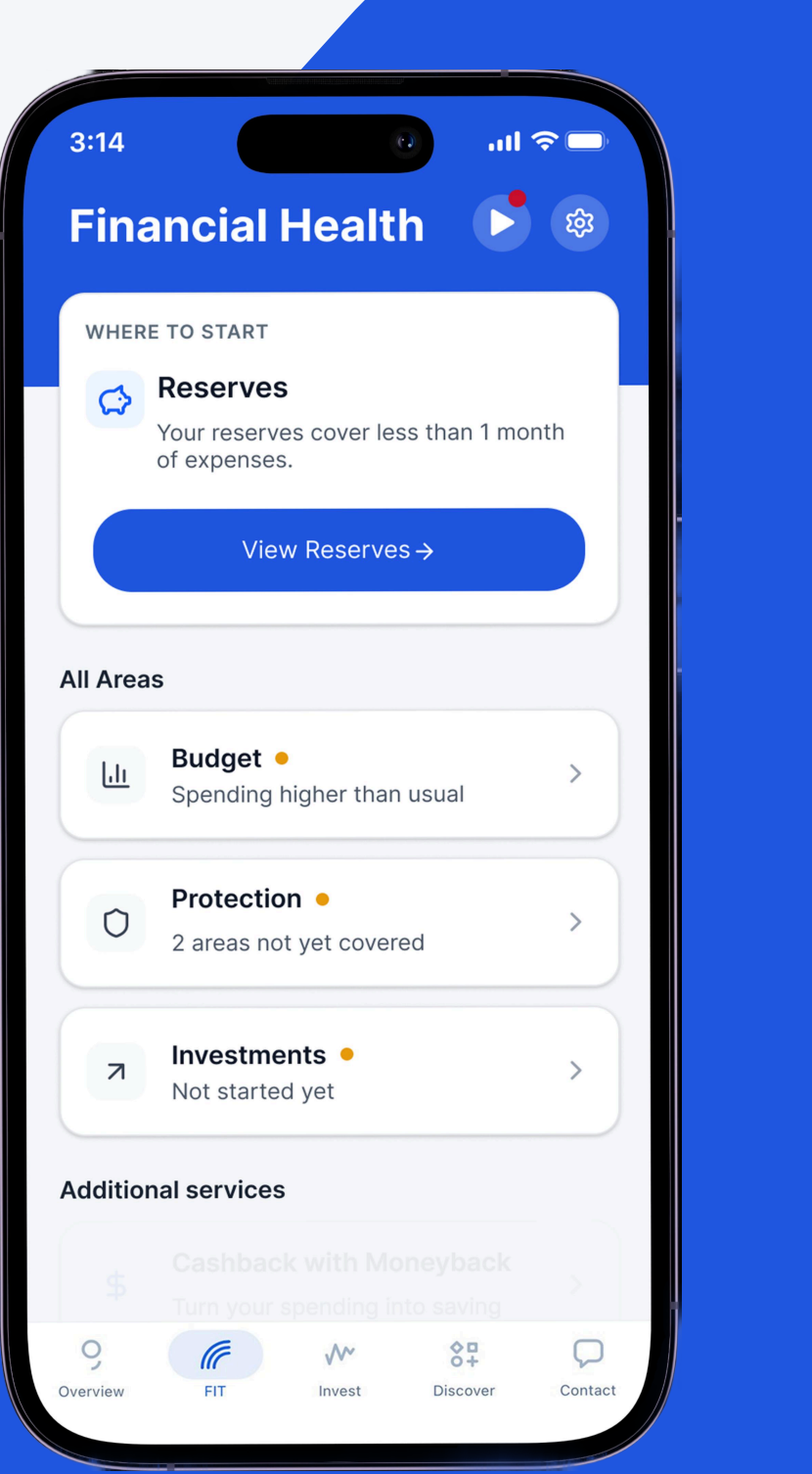
UX EXPLORATION · 2026

# From diagnosis to direction

An exploration of the Financial Health module in the George app by Erste

Cankat Olmezer · Product Designer


3:14
Financial Health
WHERE TO START
Reserves
Your reserves cover less than 1 month of expenses.
View Reserves →
All Areas
Budget
Spending higher than usual
Protection
2 areas not yet covered
Investments
Not started yet
Additional services
Overview
FIT
Invest
Discover
Contact

## Where this started...

George
UX Conf
SILVER CROWN
UHF
VHF

Hello Cankat Olmezer,

First of all we want to thank you very much for attending our first George UX Conf 😊.

If you would like to rewatch the livestream, please click here.

In order to make this event even better next time, we kindly ask you to fill out our survey so we can get insights into what worked already well and where's room for improvement.

It won't take too long (approx. 5 minutes) but it helps us a lot!

**In 2022, I attended the first George UX Conference as a student. That was my first encounter with fintech UX up close.**

**While preparing my application for a junior role at Erste, I found myself drawn back to the app.**

**The FIT module kept pulling me back. A bank that tries to help users feel in control of their finances is asking a genuinely interesting question. I wanted to explore how the experience could go further.**

**Before looking at the interface, I wanted to hear from people who actually use the app...**

## What Users Told Me

First, let me introduce them.

Emily

An expat who came to Vienna for her PhD and stayed after finding work

Lukas

A young professional who completed his master's in Vienna and recently started his first job

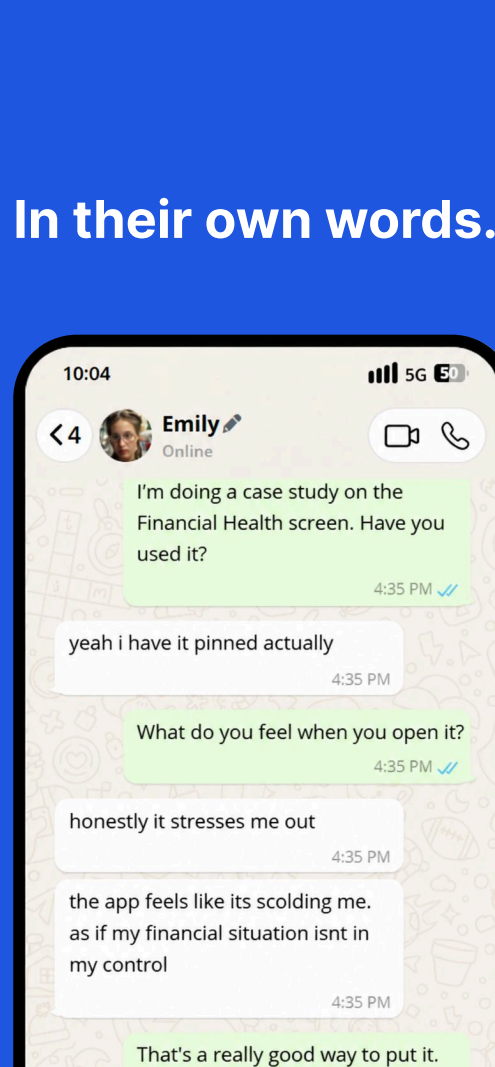
Defne

A doctoral student. Currently studying in Vienna

Felix

An Austrian native and account manager, the only participant raised inside the local banking culture

### In their own words.


10:04
Emily
Online

I'm doing a case study on the Financial Health screen. Have you used it? 4:35 PM

yeah i have it pinned actually 4:35 PM

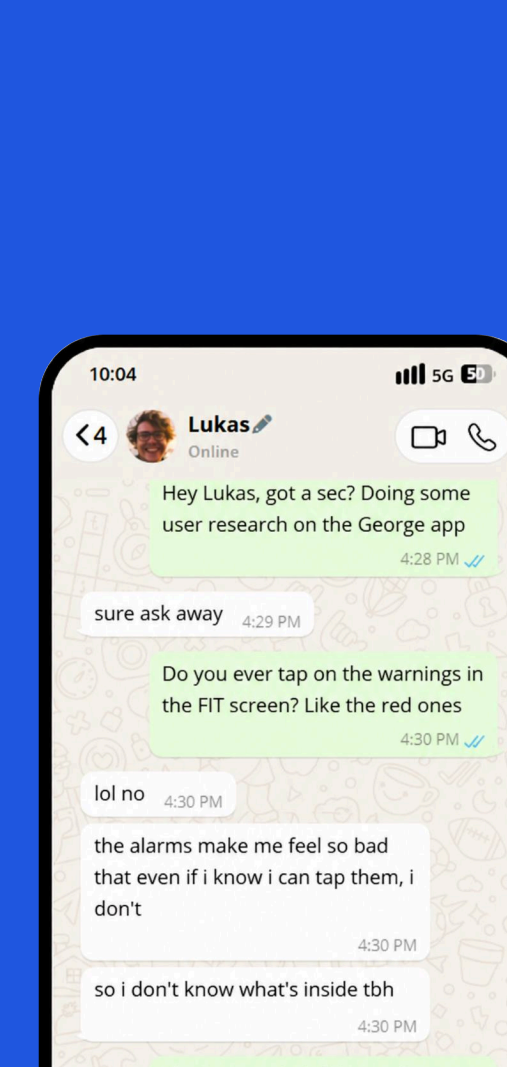
What do you feel when you open it? 4:35 PM

honestly it stresses me out 4:35 PM

the app feels like its scolding me. as if my financial situation isnt in my control 4:35 PM

That's a really good way to put it. Mind if I quote you in the case study? Anonymously 4:35 PM

go for it 4:35 PM


10:04
Lukas
Online

Hey Lukas, got a sec? Doing some user research on the George app 4:28 PM

sure ask away 4:29 PM

Do you ever tap on the warnings in the FIT screen? Like the red ones 4:30 PM

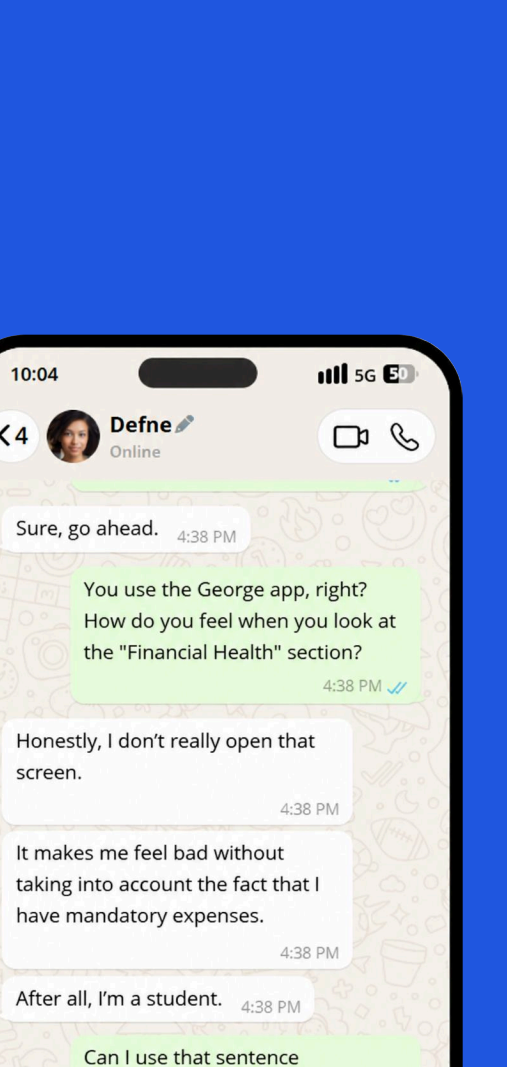
lol no 4:30 PM

the alarms make me feel so bad that even if i know i can tap them, i don't 4:30 PM

so i don't know what's inside tbh 4:30 PM

That's super helpful actually. Can I quote that anonymously? 4:30 PM

yeah sure 4:30 PM


10:04
Defne
Online

Sure, go ahead. 4:38 PM

You use the George app, right? How do you feel when you look at the "Financial Health" section? 4:38 PM

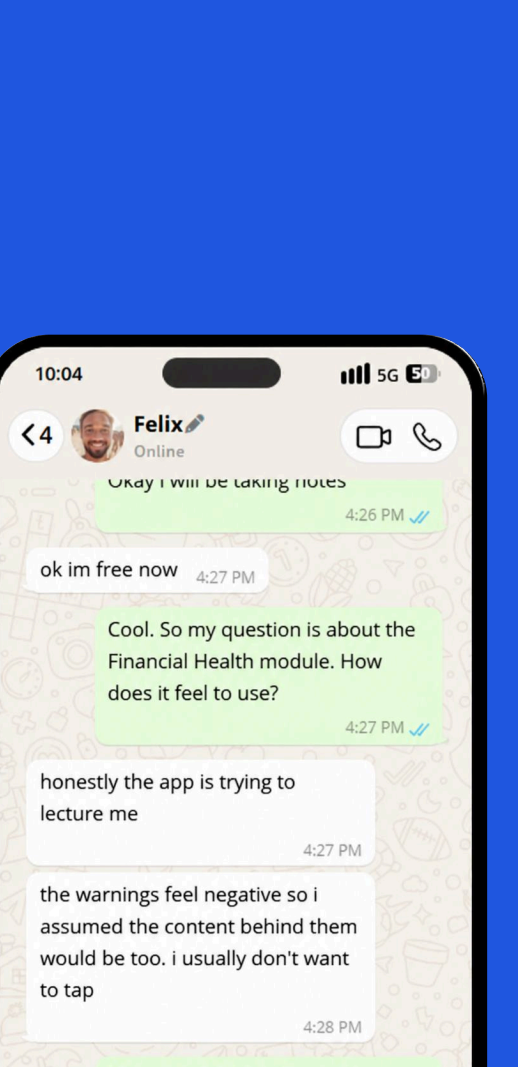
Honestly, I don't really open that screen. 4:38 PM

It makes me feel bad without taking into account the fact that I have mandatory expenses. 4:38 PM

After all, I'm a student. 4:38 PM

Can I use that sentence anonymously in my case study? 4:38 PM

Of course, good luck with it! 4:38 PM


10:04
Felix
Online

Okay i will be taking notes 4:26 PM

ok im free now 4:27 PM

Cool. So my question is about the Financial Health module. How does it feel to use? 4:27 PM

honestly the app is trying to lecture me 4:27 PM

the warnings feel negative so i assumed the content behind them would be too. i usually don't want to tap 4:28 PM

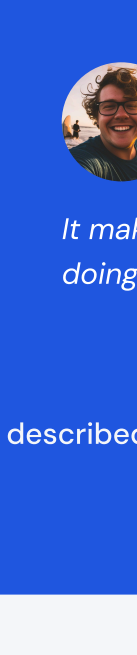
That's gold. Mind if I use this anonymously in a case study? 4:28 PM

go ahead 4:28 PM

*These conversations were real. Names and photos have been changed to keep participants anonymous.*

Emily

*The app feels like it's scolding me*



Lukas

*It makes me feel like I'm doing everything wrong.*

Defne

*It judges me without knowing my fixed expenses.*

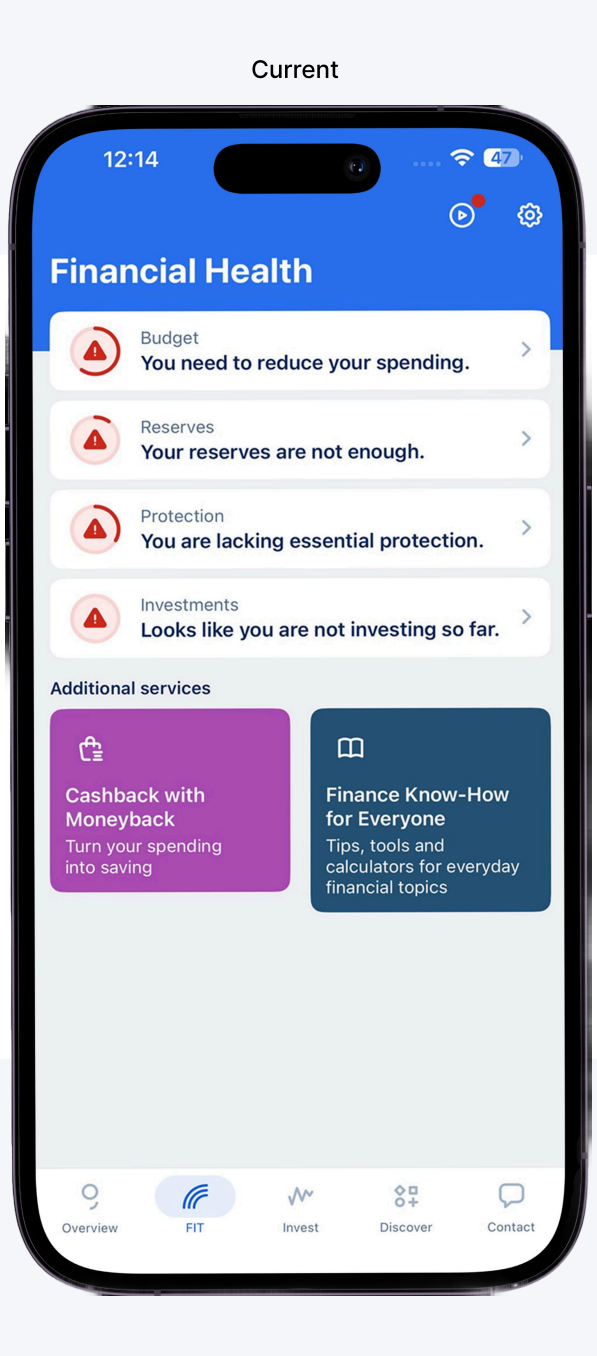
Felix

*The app is trying to lecture me.*

Across all four conversations, users described a similar emotional experience when opening the FIT screen.

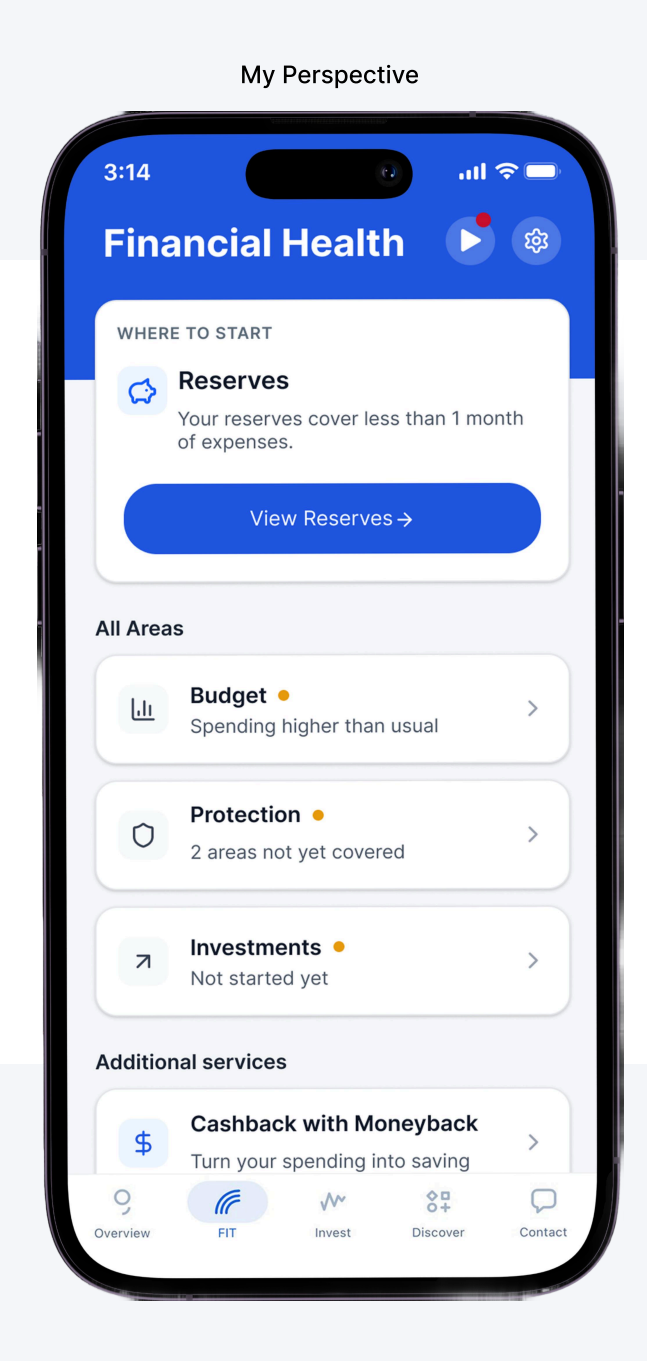
## What this led to...

Current


12:14
Financial Health
Budget
You need to reduce your spending.
Reserves
Your reserves are not enough.
Protection
You are lacking essential protection.
Investments
Looks like you are not investing so far.
Additional services
Cashback with Moneyback
Turn your spending into saving
Finance Know-How for Everyone
Tips, tools and calculators for everyday financial topics
Overview
FIT
Invest
Discover
Contact

**Across the FIT overview and four detail screens, I noticed a consistent pattern: the diagnostic information was clear, but the path forward wasn't always as visible. A few users also mentioned that opening the screen left them feeling stressed rather than supported.**

My Perspective


3:14
Financial Health
WHERE TO START
Reserves
Your reserves cover less than 1 month of expenses.
View Reserves →
All Areas
Budget
Spending higher than usual
Protection
2 areas not yet covered
Investments
Not started yet
Additional services
Cashback with Moneyback
Turn your spending into saving
Overview
FIT
Invest
Discover
Contact

**Users described feeling stressed when opening the FIT screen. When I looked at the interface, I noticed four areas presented with equal urgency and no indication of where to begin. That raised a question: if the app already knows which area needs the most attention, could it lead with that instead?**

### The principles I followed.

**01**

**Lead with the next step**

Every screen could make the smallest possible next action visible alongside the diagnostic context. When the next step lives next to the situation, users can act in the same moment they understand.

**02**

**Make goals feel reachable**

First milestones can sit alongside longer-term targets. A user with €931 in reserves may engage more with €500 saved this quarter" than with €5,655 to €9,425 eventually."

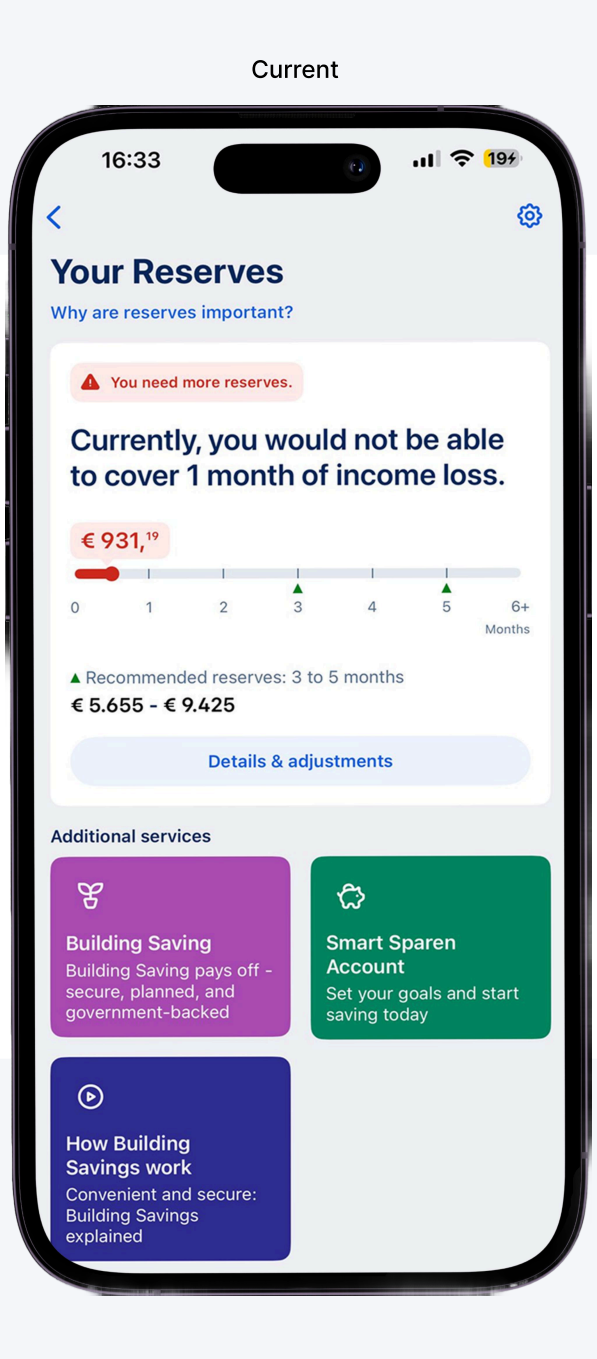
**03**

**Match the tone to the relationship**

George positions itself as a financial companion. The copy and visual treatment can lean further into that posture: observational rather than evaluative, partnered rather than corrective.

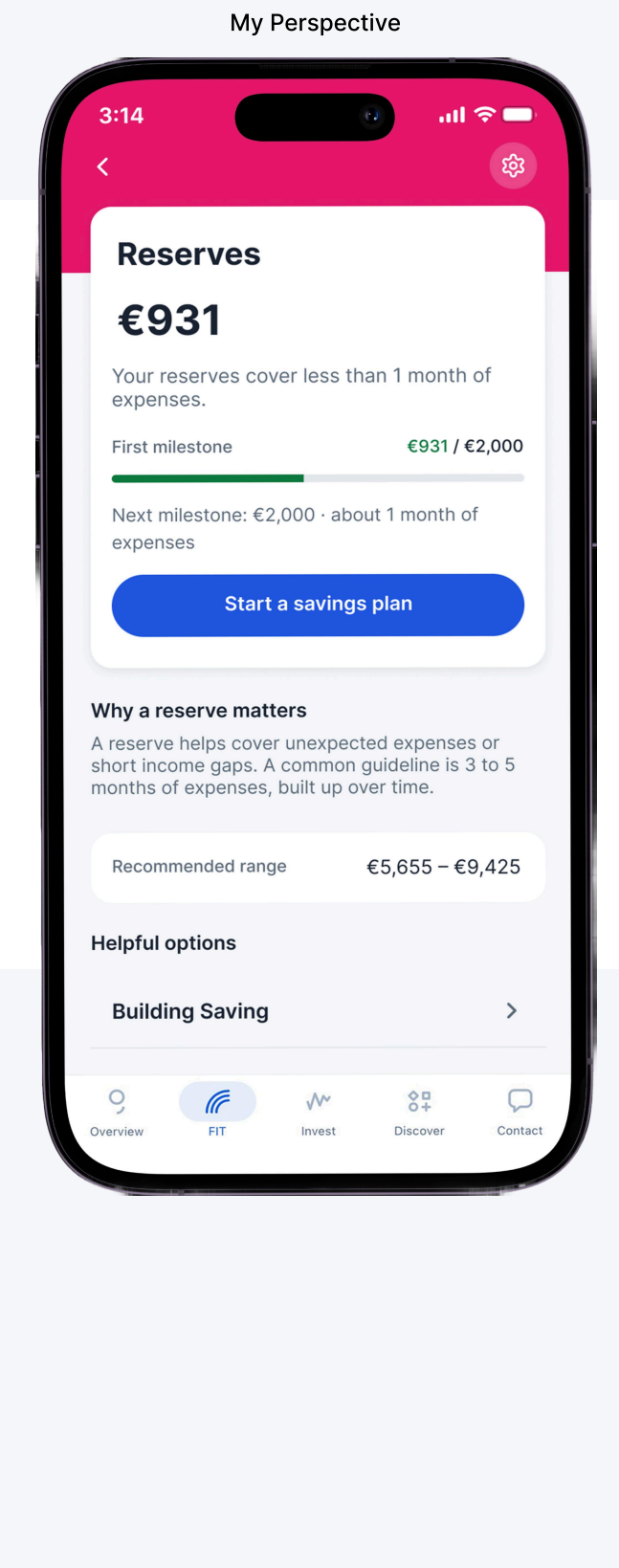
## Those conversations also made me want to look closer at the detail screens. Here is what I found.

Current


16:33
Your Reserves
Why are reserves important?
You need more reserves.
Currently, you would not be able to cover 1 month of income loss.
€ 931,19
0
1
2
3
4
5
6+
Months
Recommended reserves: 3 to 5 months
€ 5.655 - € 9.425
Details & adjustments
Additional services
Building Saving
Building Saving pays off - secure, planned, and government-backed
Smart Sparen Account
Set your goals and start saving today
How Building Savings work
Convenient and secure: Building Savings explained

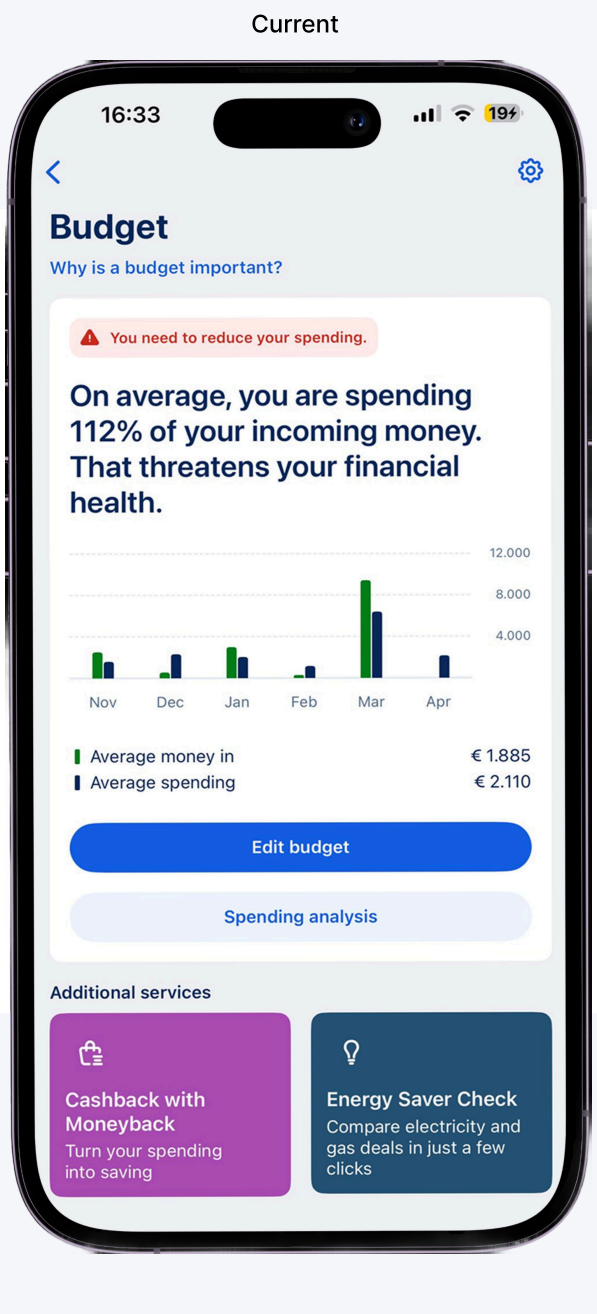
**The Reserves screen opened with an alert and a statement framed around what the user couldn't cover. The progress indicator was red, and the recommended range felt far away.**

My Perspective


3:14
Reserves
€931
Your reserves cover less than 1 month of expenses.
First milestone
€931 / €2,000
Next milestone: €2,000 · about 1 month of expenses
Start a savings plan
Why a reserve matters
A reserve helps cover unexpected expenses or short income gaps. A common guideline is 3 to 5 months of expenses, built up over time.
Recommended range
€5,655 – €9,425
Helpful options
Building Saving
Overview
FIT
Invest
Discover
Contact

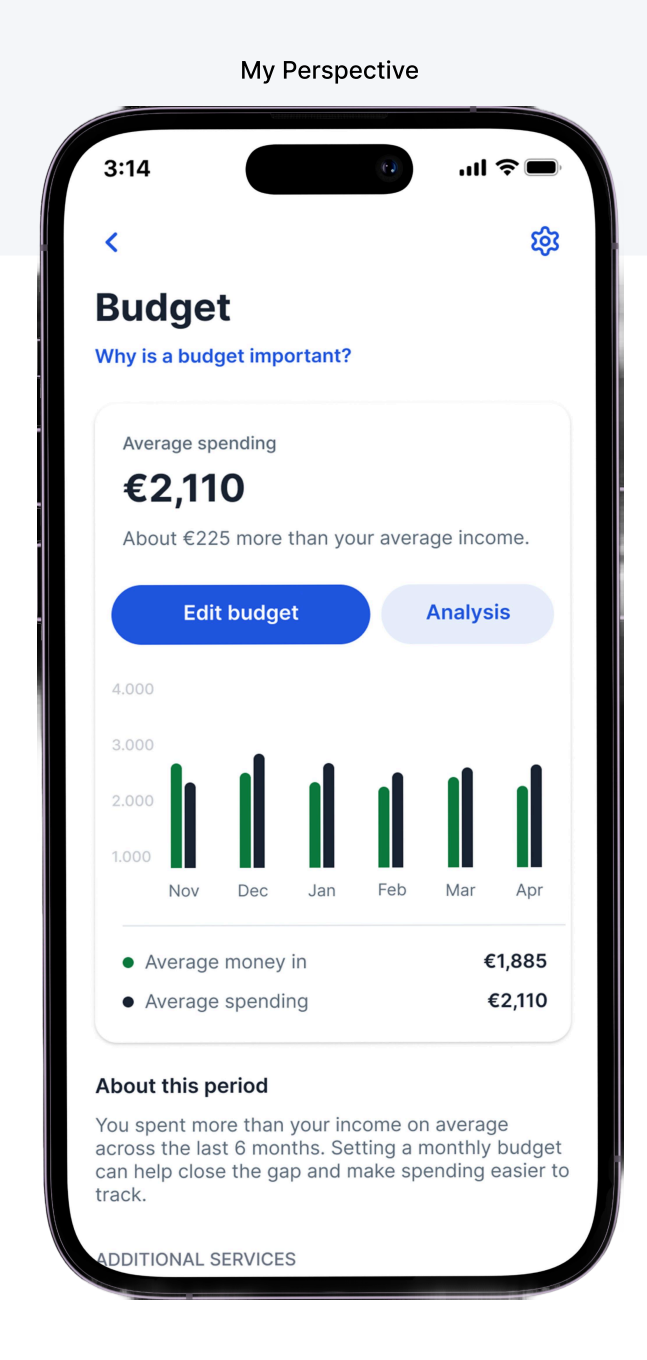
**I explored reframing the same information around a first milestone. The progress bar shifted to show how far the user had come, and the next step of starting a savings plan moved to the top.**

Current


16:33
Budget
Why is a budget important?
You need to reduce your spending.
On average, you are spending 112% of your incoming money. That threatens your financial health.
12.000
8.000
4.000
Nov
Dec
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
Average money in
€ 1.885
Average spending
€ 2.110
Edit budget
Spending analysis
Additional services
Cashback with Moneyback
Turn your spending into saving
Energy Saver Check
Compare electricity and gas deals in just a few clicks

**The Budget screen opened with an alert and a statement about overspending. The edit budget action sat below the chart, requiring the user to scroll past the diagnostic before reaching the next step.**

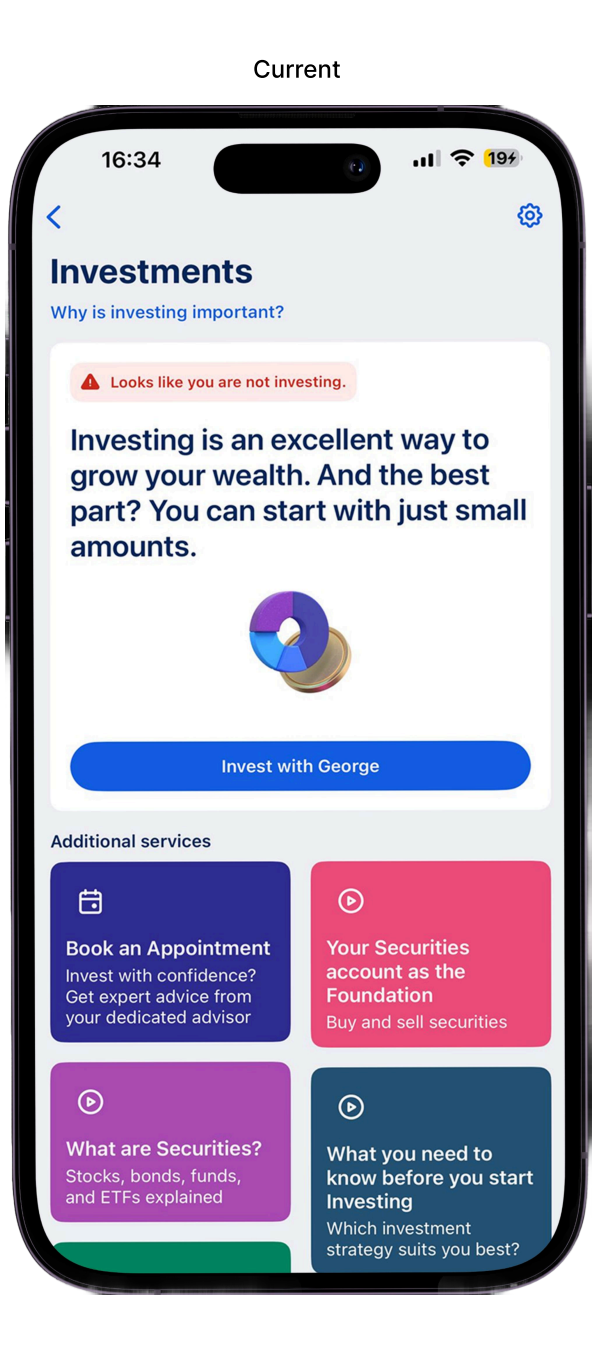
My Perspective


3:14
Budget
Why is a budget important?
Average spending
€2,110
About €225 more than your average income.
Edit budget
Analysis
4.000
3.000
2.000
1.000
Nov
Dec
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
Average money in
€1,885
Average spending
€2,110
About this period
You spent more than your income on average across the last 6 months. Setting a monthly budget can help close the gap and make spending easier to track.
ADDITIONAL SERVICES

**I moved the edit budget action to the top, so the user could act in the same moment they understood the situation. The opening shifted to show average spending with context, rather than leading with a warning.**

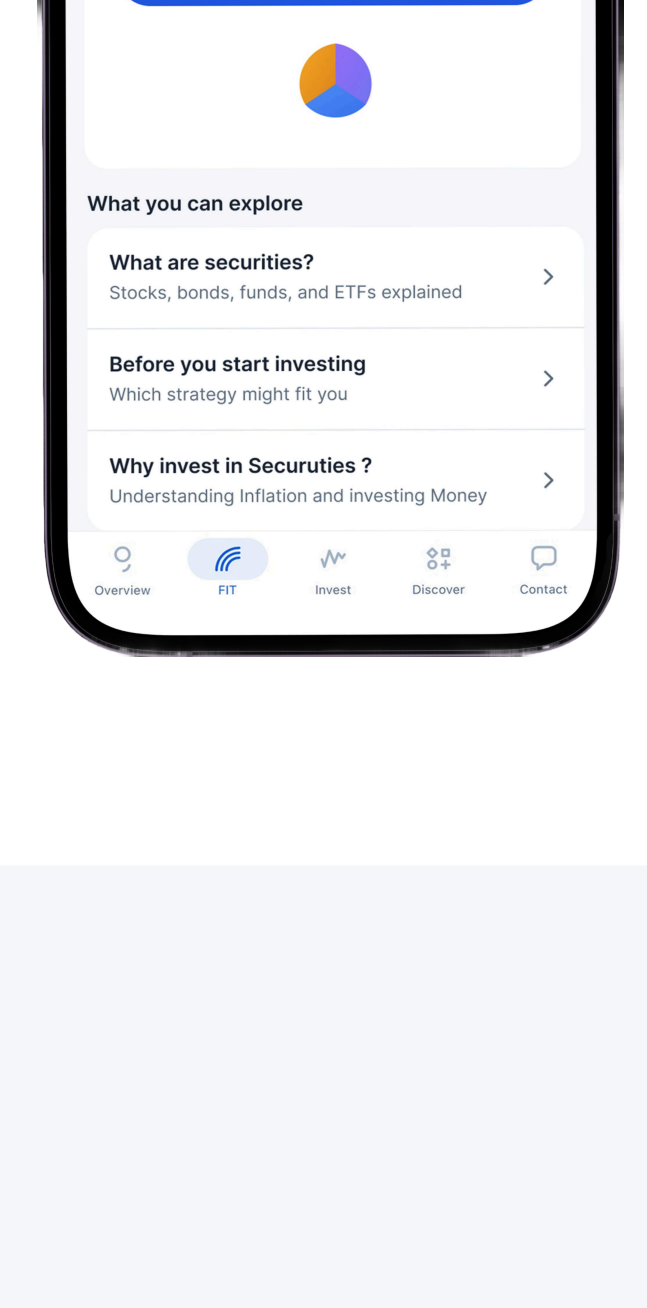
*Nielsen Norman Group, Scrolling and Attention, 2018 — nngroup.com/articles/scrolling-and-attention/*

Current


16:34
Investments
Why is investing important?
Looks like you are not investing.
Investing is an excellent way to grow your wealth. And the best part? You can start with just small amounts.
Invest with George
Additional services
Book an Appointment
Invest with confidence? Get expert advice from your dedicated advisor
Your Securities account as the Foundation
Buy and sell securities
What are Securities?
Stocks, bonds, funds, and ETFs explained
What you need to know before you start Investing
Which investment strategy suits you best?

**The same principle applied to the Investments screen.**

My Perspective


3:14
Investments
Why is investing important?
You haven't started yet
Investing can help your savings grow over time. You can start with as little as €1.
Start with €1
What you can explore
What are securities?
Stocks, bonds, funds, and ETFs explained
Before you start investing
Which strategy might fit you
Why invest in Securties ?
Understanding Inflation and investing Money
Overview
FIT
Invest
Discover
Contact

## Design System

### Colors

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| #2056E0<br>Primary actions, links | #FFFFFF<br>Card surfaces | #E5186C<br>Account headers | #E5186C<br>Body text, labels |
| #1A2332<br>Main text, amounts | #F4F6F9<br>Screen background | #8B95A1<br>Meta info | #E8EFFC<br>Secondary buttons |
| #E5E8EC<br>Row separators | #0D7A3F<br>Positive states | #E89B0C<br>Attention states | #C8102E<br>Critical only |

### Typography

INTER- text/display 32 Bold. Account amounts

INTER- text/heading-xl 28 Bold. Screen titles

INTER- text/heading-l 24 Bold. Card headers

INTER- text/heading-m 18 Semibold. Section card titles

INTER- text/body-large 16 Semibold. List row titles.

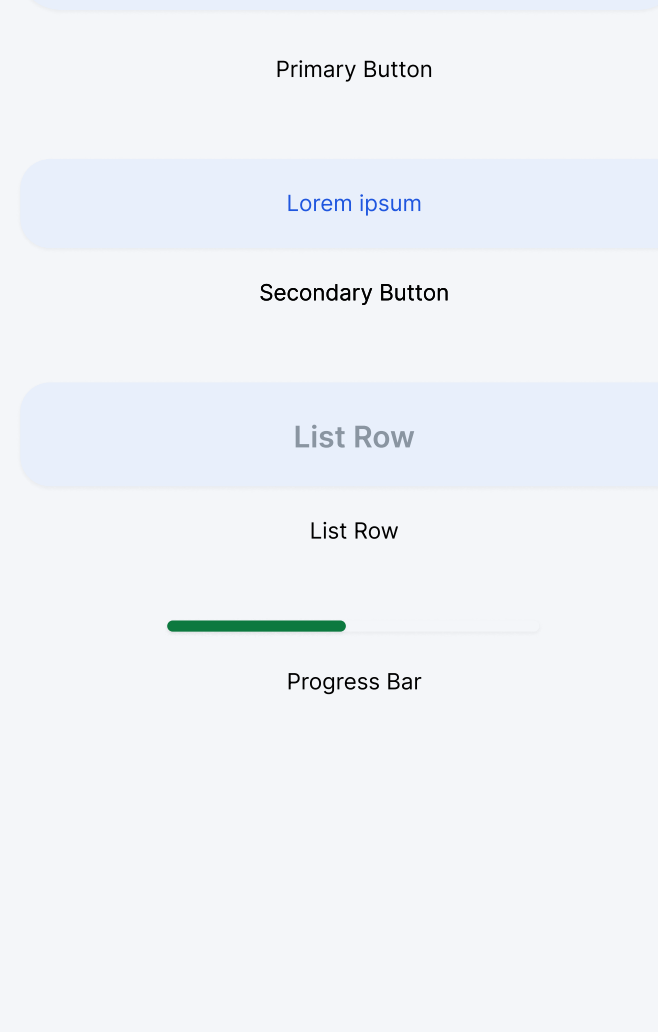
INTER- text/body 15 Regular. Default Body.

INTER- text/body-small 14 Regular. Secondary descriptions

INTER- text/label 13 Medium. Section headers

INTER- text/caption 12 Regular. Meta info

### Components


Card
Lorem ipsum
Primary Button
Lorem ipsum
Secondary Button
List Row
List Row
Progress Bar

### Tokens & Patterns

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Critical | 🟥 #C8102E | Immediate financial risk |
| Attention | 🟧 #E89B0C | Pattern needs adjustment |
| Neutral | 🟩 #0D7A3F | On track |
| Healthy | ⬛ #5C6B7A | Wealth-building opportunities |

### Tone of Voice

| *Current* | *My Perspective* |
|---|---|
| You need to reduce your spending | Your spending is higher than usual this month |
| Looks like you are not investing | You haven't started yet |
| Your reserves are not enough | Your reserves cover about 1 month of expenses |

## Where this could go next.

**01**

Protection detail screen

The same pattern from Reserves applies here. The principle transfers directly.

**02**

Discover and Contact tabs

I noticed broader navigation opportunities, but they belong to a different exploration.

**03**

Notification copy

Notification copy and push messages felt like a natural continuation of this exploration.

Does the "Where to start" card increase tap-through compared to four equal warnings?

Does the near milestone framing of €2,000 increase savings plan setup compared to the distant target of €5,655?

**Without analytics, I would run moderated usability sessions with 5 to 8 George users, comparing the original and reimagined flows. Key metric: time to first action and emotional response after task completion.**

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UX Exploration - Erste

Thanks for Watching.

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